

26.00 Wood Islands

Shoreline length: 7 km



Shore Types

Wood Islands is a harbour located on the southeast end of PEI. Shore type characterized by a majority of low plains and vertical structures.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
21	10	9	3	7	28	12	10

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

Located within the Rural Municipality of Belfast, this SMU is the site of a Provincial Park, plus two federally owned facilities:

- The Wood Islands Ferry Terminal, which is federally owned and operated. As one of two access points to Prince Edward Island, Route 1, of the TCH and the Ferry Terminal is a key infrastructure in addition to serving as an economic driver for the entire province.
- Small Craft Harbour managed by DFO

There are no legacy subdivisions or no small lots noted in this SMU.

Natural Assets and Heritage

Recreational sites include the Wood Islands Provincial Park (playground, beach) and the Wood Islands Lighthouse.

The shoreline includes critical habitat for bird species including the endangered Piping Plover and threatened Bank Swallow.

Planning and Policy Framework

The Wood Islands Ferry Terminal itself is federally owned and operated and may be subject to a separate federal environmental or planning framework.

Sediment transport

The sediment transport rates are low inside the harbour and high along the exposed south and east shores.

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

Infrastructure within in this area are vulnerable to increasing flood and erosion hazards. The following flood risk indicator is based on the even with 1% annual exceedance probability (100-year return) with increasing amounts of sea level rise (SLR). The erosion risk indicator is based on potential future shoreline change for areas with historical data, not including salt marshes.

Estimated number of buildings and length of road at risk [per km shoreline].

	FLOOD RISK				EROSION RISK		
	Present	Short-term 0.3m SLR (2050)	Medium-term 0.6m SLR (2080)	Long-term 1.2m SLR (2130)	Short-term (~2050)	Medium-term (~2080)	Long-term (~2130)
Buildings	21 [3/km]	23 [3/km]	23 [3/km]	23 [3/km]	4 [1/km]	19 [3/km]	23 [3/km]
Roads	1641 m [220 m/km]	1729 m [232 m/km]	1780 m [239 m/km]	1847 m [248 m/km]	321 m [43 m/km]	502 m [67 m/km]	1003 m [135 m/km]

Proposed SMP Strategies

The primary strategy for is Resist due to the critical nature of the infrastructure.

	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
Sea level rise range	0 – 0.3 m	0.3 – 0.6 m	0.6 – 1.2 m
Potential timeframe	2030 - 2050	2050 - 2080	2080 - 2130
Proposed SMU strategy	R	R	R
Rationale	The recommended strategy is Resist due to the critical nature of the infrastructure. The Resist strategy would be suitable to maintain a functional harbour for the Ferry and fishing fleet. The south cliff is habitat for the threatened bank swallow; strategies should consider hybrid methods with beach nourishment as alternatives to armouring.		

The table above shows how the recommended shoreline management unit (SMU) or policy unit (PU) strategy evolves across three planning epochs (Short-, Medium-, and Long-term) under increasing sea-level rise and erosion projections.

Adaptation strategies are preliminary recommendations subject to further development with feedback from community and government. These strategies are not approvals, commitments or policy determinations.